

Augmented visiting card

Design your own AR visiting card
www.visualcard.me



Trendy eye wear?

Vuzix augmented reality
Wrap 920AR

software. Wearable glasses are also going to be available soon, and if companies



AR of tomorrow

like Vuzix have their way, at least we won't end up looking like cyborgs. Alas, unless we see Steve Jobs unveil such an innovation, it is going to continue

to be a hammer in search of nails.

The software is present on almost all modern smartphones today and examples of such applications are the Layar browser and the Junaio browser which can be found on both the iPhone and Android. The Ovi store from Nokia also has many AR applications if you wish to get your hands dirty.

The problem however for us in the real world today is the content. There is just not enough content in the AR world today to give users that nudge they need to whip out their mobile phone and look around. Content creation is primarily a user oriented task and you can find a very nice example of user created content in the 'Tweeps Around' app that runs in the Layar browser.

Limitations

AR is not all rosy though. It has limitations where GPS accuracy comes into the picture. Until we see an accuracy of less than one meter in our own hand held devices, we won't be able to truly leverage what it has to offer. But it is starting to show signs of improvement. Intel recently used AR at their annual Developers Conference to give users of AR browsers directions to various venues where the events were taking place, and it worked indoors! Now that's useful.



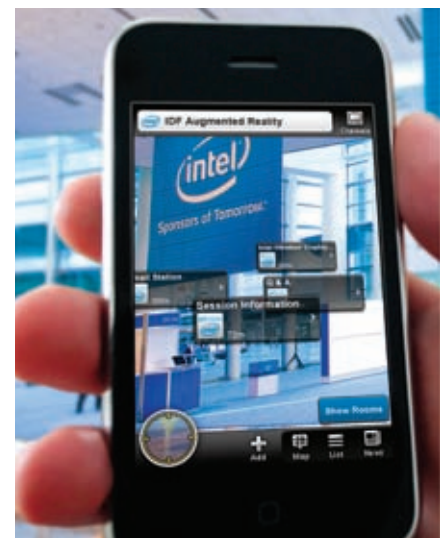
Augmented reality used in social networking

Look into the crystal ball

Once using AR becomes second nature, things like interaction with button presses and 3D animations being used for presentations (.ppt 2020?) will become commonplace. Content will be pushed on to our field of view instead of only requesting for it and we cannot even begin to explain the new frontiers it will open for education and engineering.



Content is king but context is queen: AR must work for us, not against us



IDF 2010 with AR indoors

Imagine taking driving lessons from the windscreen in front of you, with a yellow paved road showing you the way. It's better than sitting in front of a computer because it is reality you are experiencing, but you have information at your disposal right in front of your eyes! There are possibilities of it becoming 'in your face' as well should the early adopter not ensure the blocking of unwanted content.

All in all, by the time we get to experience augmented reality integrated into the facets of our daily lives here in India, we will probably be reading an augmented reality version of the Digit ebook in the comfort of our rocking chairs, wondering about the time gone by and how far we have come. **d**